

You can access the brightness/contrast tool from Image > Adjustments > Brightness/Contrast. The new values can be entered numerically (prefixed by a “-” sign for reducing the

levels) or by moving the slider to the left to decrease or right to increase.



For The Designer Geek—Gamma Correction

While speaking of Brightness control, we have to mention the concept of *gamma correction*. You've probably seen the Adobe Gamma applet in the Windows Control Panel, and might have even ventured to try it. Gamma, in computer graphics terminology, refers to the brightness correction that has to be applied to an image such that it is displayed in the same way it was created, even when viewed on another system.

Graphics cards, software and sometimes even monitors do not represent brightness in the same intensity. Hence, there is a chance that the picture you created might look good on your setup, but when viewed on a Mac, for example, might appear with a different brightness level. This is where the gamma correction tool comes in handy. You need to know the amount of correction the other device(s) needs and apply that correction in the photo editing software; of course, the classic trial-and-error method can be used to arrive at an optimal setting.

In Photoshop CS2, gamma correction can be found under Image > Adjustments > Expose.